

Now you can run all the applications with a simple command like...

```
$ sh automate.sh
```

Please remember that the opened window will close as soon as the command that is running stops executing. For example, the window/terminal running `tail -f /var/log/messages` will immediately shut off if you don't have permission to read `/var/log/messages`.

—Shiv Premani, shivpremani@gmail.com



Back up MBR with the dd command

Here's how you can do it:

```
# dd if=/dev/sdX of=/tmp/sda-mbr.bin bs=512 count=1
```

Replace *X* with the actual device name, for example, `/dev/sda`.

And here's how you can restore the partition table to the disk:

```
# dd if= sda-mbr.bin of=/dev/sdX bs=1 count=64 skip=446 seek=446
```

—Remin Raphael, remin13@gmail.com



Copy, paste and cut operations in the Vim editor

In order to copy a line of text in Vim, place the mouse on the line and press "Esc yy". If there is more than one line from the mouse pointer then prepend yy with the number (of lines) like this: "Esc 3yy". This will copy three lines. Observe the statement "*n* lines yanked" (where 'yanked' means copied) at the bottom of the file.

Now, to cut a line, place the mouse on the line and press "Esc dd". If you want to cut more than one line, e.g., three lines, press "Esc 3dd".

Finally, to paste, move the mouse to one line above the row where you want to paste, and press "Esc p".

—Indraveni, indravenik@cdac.in



Vim tips on auto completion

When cranking out code, or even writing docs, Vim can do a lot for you. It can do word/pattern/line completion using `^x ^n ^p` and `^x ^L` (Note that the ^x character means you have to hold down the Ctrl key and then press x.)

For example, open an existing 'C' source file in [g]vim, go to insert or append mode, type `prix^p`, and you should get a pop-up showing word completion choices which includes `printf` (and `printk` in a kernel module!).

You can also do `prix^L`, which will give you an option to select complete lines that start with 'pri' to auto complete.

Important caveats:

1. You need to be in insert mode.

2. The word/line completion appears to work only with 'existing' words (or lines) in the current file. (So if you don't have a `printf` in there, `prix^p` won't complete the 'pri' snippet to `printf`).

Nevertheless, it's still very useful!

Resource: <http://www.thegeekstuff.com/2009/01/vi-and-vim-editor-5-awesome-examples-for-automatic-word-completion-using-ctrl-x-magic>

—Kaiwan Billimoria, kaiwan@designergraphix.com



CLI calculator

`bc` is an arbitrary precision calculator language.

You can use it by simply typing `bc` in a command prompt and then query your calculation like `1+2` or `3-2`, etc.

You can also use it in your shell scripts. For example, if you want to find the square roots for numbers, then simply create a file called `sqr.sh` and add the following content:

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
if [ $# -ne 1 ]
```

```
then
```

```
echo "Usage: sqr number"
```

```
exit 1
```

```
else
```

```
echo -e "sqr($1)\nquit\n" | bc -q -i
```

```
fi
```

Now make the file executable by using the following:

```
# chmod +x sqr.sh
```

That's all. You can test it now by trying to look up the square root of 36.

```
$/sqr.sh 36
```

```
sqr(36)
```

```
6
```

```
quit
```

—fayiz mustahafa, fayizk1@yahoo.com

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